

wear the Egyptian breastplate.⁷ As soon as they hear of any luxury, they instantly make it their own: and hence, among other novelties, they have learnt unnatural lust from the Greeks. Each of them has several wives, and a still larger number of concubines.

136. Next to prowess in arms, it is regarded as the greatest proof of manly excellence, to be the father of many sons.⁸ Every year the king sends rich gifts to the man who can show the largest number: for they hold that number is strength. Their sons are carefully instructed from their fifth to their twentieth year,⁹ in three things alone,—to ride, to draw the bow, and to speak the truth.¹⁰ Until their fifth year they are not allowed to come into the sight of their father, but pass their lives with the women. This is done that, if the child die young, the father may not be afflicted by its loss.

añts have invariably a long flowing robe (A), while soldiers and persons of minor importance wear a close-fitting dress, fastened by a belt, and trousers meeting at the ancles a high shoe (B). It seems probable that the costume (A) is that which Herodotus and Xenophon call the Median, while the close-fitting dress (B) is the old Persian garb.

⁷ The Egyptian corslets are noticed again (ii. 182, and vii. 89). For a description of them, see Sir G. Wilkinson's note to Book ii. ch. 182.

⁸ Sheikh Ali Mirza, a son of the well-known Futteh Ali Shah, was accounted the proudest and happiest man in the empire, because, when he rode out on state occasions, he was attended by a body-guard of sixty of his own sons. At the time of Futteh Ali Shah's death his direct descendants amounted to nearly three thousand, some of them being in the fifth degree, and every Persian in consequence felt a pride in being the subject of such a king. The greatest misfortune, indeed, that can befall a man in Persia is to be childless. When a chief's "*hearthstone*," as it was said, "*was dark*," he lost all respect, and hence arose the now universal practice of adoption.—[H. C. R.]

⁹ Xenophon, in his romance (Cyrop. i. ii. § 8), makes the first period of education end with the sixteenth or seventeenth year, after which he says there followed a second period of ten years. It was not till the completion of this second period that the Persian became a full citizen (τέλειος). In all this, it is evident, we have only the philosophic notions of the Greeks. Perhaps even in Herodotus we have Greek speculations rather than history. He does not appear to have travelled in Persia Proper.

¹⁰ The Persian regard for truth has been questioned by Larcher on the strength of the speech of Darius in Book iii. (ch. 72). This speech, however, is entirely unhistoric. The special estimation in which truth was held among the Persians is evidenced in a remarkable manner by the inscriptions of Darius, where *lying* is taken as the representative of all evil. It is the great calamity of the usurpation of the pseudo-Smerdis, that "then the *lie* became abounding in the land" (Behist. Ins. Col. i. Par. 10). "The Evil One (?) invented *lies* that they should deceive the state" (Col. iv. Par. 4). Darius is favoured by Ormazd, "because he was not a heretic, nor a *liar*, nor a tyrant" (Col. iv. Par. 13). His successors are exhorted not to cherish, but to cast into utter perdition, "the man who may be a *liar*, or who may be an evil doer" (ib. Par. 14). His great fear is lest it may be thought that any part of the record which he has set up has been "*falsely* related," and he even abstains from narrating certain events of his reign "lest to him who may hereafter peruse the tablet, the many deeds that have been done by him may seem to be *falsely* recorded" (ib. Par. 6 and 8).